

Were You There?

Spiritual, arranged by HALL JOHNSON

With changing "colors," but steady tempo

Piano

The piano introduction consists of two staves. The right hand plays a series of chords in a descending sequence, starting with a piano (*p*) dynamic and moving to a mezzo-forte (*mf*) dynamic. The left hand provides a steady bass line with eighth notes.

Voice

The first system of the song features a voice melody line and piano accompaniment. The voice part begins with a piano (*p*) dynamic and includes four lines of lyrics with corresponding dynamics: *mf*, *pp*, and *f*. The piano accompaniment continues with the same chordal pattern as the introduction.

p Were you there when they cru - ci - fied my Lord?
mf Were you there when they nailed Him to the tree?
pp Were you there when they laid Him in the tomb?
f Were you there when they rolled the stone a - way?

The second system of the song continues the voice melody and piano accompaniment. The voice part includes four lines of lyrics for a second vocal part, each starting with a blank line for the singer's name. The piano accompaniment remains consistent with the previous system.

____ Were you there when they cru - ci - fied my Lord?
 ____ Were you there when they nailed Him to the tree?
 ____ Were you there when they laid Him in the tomb?
 ____ Were you there when they rolled the stone a - way?

Oh, _____ some - times it caus - es me to trem - ble, trem - ble,

p *pp*

trem - ble, _____

Were you there when they cru - ci - fied my
 Were you there when they nailed Him to the
 Were you there when they laid Him in the
pp Were you there when they cru - ci - fied my

1-3 4 *rall.*

Lord?
 tree?
 tomb?

Lord? Were you there?

rall.